

Best file management tips for devices

Organised files make it easier to locate documents and reduce duplicate files. Here's how to get started, if you haven't done this before.

Cloud storage solutions (Google Drive, Dropbox)

- **Google Drive:** Offers 15GB of free storage. Automatically syncs files across devices.
- **Dropbox:** Provides seamless file sharing and synchronisation.

How to name and organise digital folders

- **Consistent Naming Conventions:** Use clear, descriptive names for files and folders.
- **Folder Hierarchies:** Organise folders by category, date, or project.
- **Regular Clean-Up:** Set aside time monthly to delete unnecessary files.

3) How to reduce your carbon footprint with eco-friendly tech choices

Technology use contributes to energy consumption and environmental impact. Making conscious choices can help reduce your carbon footprint, and this is what to consider to make more environmentally friendly tech buying and usage decisions in the New Year 2025.

How to optimise power usage settings

Believe it or not, and this isn't something that most people think about day in and day out, but small adjustments to your device settings can lead to significant energy savings. Here's how you start your power optimization journey.

Energy-saving settings for devices

- **Enable Power Saving Modes:** Reduces performance and background activity to save energy.
- **Adjust Screen Brightness:** Lower brightness conserves battery life.
- **Use Dark Mode:** On devices with OLED screens, dark mode can reduce power consumption.

Using smart plugs and power strips

- **Smart Plugs:** Schedule devices to turn off when not in use.
- **Advanced Power Strips:** Automatically cut power to devices in standby mode, reducing phantom energy use.

Understanding impact of OTT streaming services

Streaming services consume significant data and energy, in case you didn't know this already. Here's something to keep in mind before starting your next weekend binge watching session.

Data and power usage by streaming services

High-definition streaming uses more data and requires more energy from data centres and your device.

- **HD Streaming:** Uses up to 3GB per hour.
- **SD Streaming:** Uses about 0.7GB per hour.

Adjusting quality settings to conserve energy

- **Lower Video Quality:** Set streaming services to standard definition when high resolution isn't necessary – especially when you're going to consume streaming media on your smartphone, for example.
- **Download Content:** Download shows or music when on Wi-Fi to reduce data usage on mobile networks.

Choosing to buy sustainable gadgets

Opt for devices that are environmentally friendly. This may not be very easy, but device manufacturers are increasingly making their sustainability story known to their consumers. Start paying attention to them.

Brands offering eco-friendly options

- **Fairphone:** Modular smartphones designed for longevity and reparability.
- **Apple, Dell, HP, Lenovo:** Just to name a few manufacturers that offer laptops with recycled materials and energy-efficient designs.

Tips for buying refurbished electronics

- **Certified Refurbished:** Purchase from reputable sellers who offer warranties.
- **Check Specifications:** Ensure the device meets your needs despite being pre-owned.
- **Environmental Impact:** Refurbished devices reduce electronic waste.

4) Setting boundaries for work-life balance

With the lines between work and personal life blurring, setting digital boundaries is crucial to rescue yourselves from the depths of digital hell.

How to use 'Do Not Disturb' and 'Focus' modes

These features help minimise distractions during personal or focused work times.

How to setup and customise Focus modes

- **iOS:** Go to Settings > Focus. Create custom modes like "Work" or "Personal" to allow notifications only from selected apps and contacts.
- **Android:** Use Digital Wellbeing settings to set up Focus Mode, pausing distracting apps.